

The Lede

What Would Free Buses Look Like, Actually?

Zohran Mamdani has promised to make the bus fare-free, and so has Andrew Cuomo, sort of. Is New York City ready?

By Naaman Zhou

August 28, 2025



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*[Naaman Zhou](#) is a member of *The New Yorker*'s editorial staff. He was previously a reporter for the *Guardian Australia*.*

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